

# Final-years in placement season, at Tier-2/3 colleges in Telangana & AP

## Who exactly



Sai, 21. B.Tech CSE, 2027 batch, JNTU-affiliated college. Campus drives in Nov-Jan. Resume project: copied from YouTube. Has sat through “free webinars” that were sales pitches. Lives in WhatsApp: class, placement, hostel groups.

Primary: Final-year (2027) CSE/IT/AI-ML.

Secondary: ECE/EEE/Mech students switching to IT roles.

Why first: NxtWave’s home market, and the year a real project changes an interview.

## Why they’d care

1. Interview pressure. “Tell me about your project” and, now, “have you worked with AI?”
2. Resume gap. No real, deployed project they can open and defend.
3. AI FOMO. Everyone talks about AI; almost nobody in their batch has built with it.

## What makes them register

1. A concrete outcome: a live AI app + GitHub repo + resume line in 60 min. Not “learn AI”.
2. A trusted invite: a batchmate in the class group beats any brand ad.
3. Zero risk: Free, Sunday, no setup, honest about the 8-minute pitch.
4. Status: squad rewards + College Wars.

**Insight** → the bottleneck isn’t awareness, it’s trust. Students ignore brand webinars; they open what a batchmate forwards. So the plan buys distribution through people, not impressions.

## 3 channels + 1 loop. Prioritised, and what I'm deliberately NOT doing

### ■ #1 Quest Leaders → class WhatsApp groups ~270

Do: 30 campus ambassadors post a tracked link + Tenglish/Hinglish message into ~4 class & placement WhatsApp groups each, then DM close friends.

Why it works: Final-years trust a batchmate in their class group far more than a brand ad. Each group is ~65 people who already share placement updates there.

### ■ #2 Club & T&P co-hosts ~100

Do: 10 tech clubs / placement cells co-host: "in association with <club>". They broadcast to final-years through official groups and notice boards.

Why it works: Clubs need events on their calendar (and for NAAC reports); T&P cells want placement prep. A free, co-branded workshop is an easy yes and carries official credibility.

### ■ #3 Squad referral loop ~150

Do: Every registrant gets a Quest Pass, a personal link and a one-tap WhatsApp share. Rewards unlock at 1, 3 and 5 friends. College Wars leaderboard adds peer pressure.

Why it works: Students go to workshops with friends. The loop turns ~370 seeded registrations into a distribution channel at zero cost.

### 🚫 Not doing (and why)

- Paid Instagram/Meta ads. At realistic student CPLs (~₹15-40), ₹2,000 buys 50-130 sign-ups with weak show-up.
- Cash / iPad lucky draws. They attract people who want the prize, not the workshop.
- Fake scarcity. "Only 50 seats" on a Zoom call burns the trust the plan runs on.
- Cold-emailing T&P officers. Too slow for 7 days; reach them through student club leads instead.

### 💡 Message: A/B test, not a guess

A · Build an AI project for your resume in 60 mins. Free, live, this Sunday.

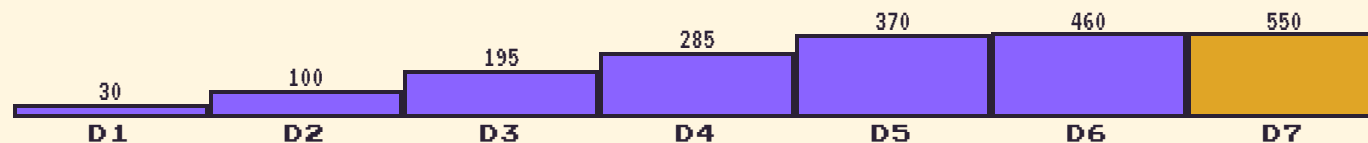
B · Interviewers are asking "have you worked with AI?". Have a real answer by Sunday.

Split Days 1-3 via tracked links, then roll the winner out. Copy in Tenglish/Hinglish, as students actually text.

# The math: base case 550 (10% buffer), with a Day-3 tripwire

| CHANNEL                                                                             | REACH                                                | CLICK | VISITS | CONV. | SIGN-UPS |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------|--------|-------|----------|
| <div><div></div> Quest Leaders</div> <div>30 leaders × 4 groups × 6S students</div> | 7,800                                                | 10%   | 780    | 35%   | 270      |
| <div><div></div> Club co-hosts</div> <div>10 partners × 300 final-years</div>       | 3,000                                                | 8%    | 240    | 40%   | 100      |
| <div><div></div> Organic social</div> <div>posts by leaders</div>                   | 1,500                                                | 5%    | 75     | 40%   | 30       |
| <div><div></div> Squad loop</div> <div>- 370 seeded sign-ups × K-Factor 0.4</div>   | 39% share their pass · - 1.2 Friends join per sharer |       |        |       | 150      |
| Total                                                                               | goal 500 · buffer +50                                |       |        |       | 550      |

Cumulative target the dashboard tracks



## ⚡ Downside case

IF WhatsApp click-through halves and the loop stalls (<K 0.2S), we land near ~300. That's why there's a tripwire.

## 🚩 Day-3 tripwire: < 150?

Plan B: +20 Quest Leaders From NxtWave's learner community, ask For NxtWave's own Instagram/YouTube/email, and extend College Wars by a day.

## 📅 Design for show-up, not just sign-ups

500 sign-ups with 19% attendance is a failed workshop. WhatsApp reminders + a D-1 setup nudge target ~40% show-up → ~200 live builders.

## 7 days, ₹2,000, measured daily

|           |                                       |                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>D1</b> | <b>Recruit &amp; arm</b><br>target 30 | Recruit 30 Quest Leaders (NxtWave learner community, club leads, LinkedIn). Send kits: link, messages, poster. Soft-launch to friends. |
| <b>D2</b> | <b>Wave 1</b><br>target 100           | Leaders post in class + placement groups (7-9 PM, when groups are active). Confirm 10 club / T&P co-hosts.                             |
| <b>D3</b> | <b>Checkpoint</b><br>target 195       | Pick the winning hook (A/B). IF < 150 registrations, trigger Plan B: +20 leaders and ask NxtWave for owned channels.                   |
| <b>D4</b> | <b>College Wars</b><br>target 285     | Post the leaderboard into every group: "CVR is #1, your college is #4". Competition drives the second wave.                            |
| <b>D5</b> | <b>Social proof</b><br>target 370     | Wave 2 message with live count ("370 Anal-years from 40+ colleges") + Quest Pass statuses on WhatsApp.                                 |
| <b>D6</b> | <b>Squad push</b><br>target 460       | Reward unlock reminders to everyone with 0-2 referrals. College Wars closes at midnight.                                               |
| <b>D7</b> | <b>Last call</b><br>target 550        | Registration closes 10 PM. Switch every channel to show-up mode: setup checklist + reminders.                                          |

🛡️ **Risks → mitigations**

- Group admins mute forwards → leaders post as a personal note + DM friends
- Sign-ups don't show → D-1 setup nudge, H-1 link, live +10 rescue
- Junk / duplicate sign-ups → phone dedupe, year field, quality metric

💰 **Budget • ₹2,000**

|                                                                |        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| ★ Quest Leader prizes (top 3: ₹500 / ₹300 / ₹200)              | ₹1,000 |
| ★ Squad prizes (top referrer ₹300 + 2 lucky draws ₹100)        | ₹500   |
| WhatsApp reminders: ~1,650 utility msgs × ₹0.17 (₹0.145 + GST) | ₹300   |
| QR posters for notice boards (~40 prints)                      | ₹200   |

★ = paid only on results: 75% of budget. ≈ ₹3.6 per registration.

📊 **Daily scoreboard → decisions**

- Sign-ups vs curve • conversion by channel • K-factor
- Leader < 3 sign-ups after 2 days → nudge or reassign
- Hook winner by end of D3 → every link switches
- Quality: ≥ 80% Anal-years, or Rx targeting

# Not just a landing page: the engine that runs all three channels

## ★ Register + attribution

Every visit carries ref code, UTM and A/B hook bucket. Registration in 30 s.

## 📄 Quest Pass + squad loop

Shareable pass image (QR) for WhatsApp Status, invite copy in English / Tenglish / Hinglish, rewards at 1/3/5.

## 👑 College Wars

Live college, squad and leader leaderboards: the peer-pressure engine for days 4-6.

## 🚩 Quest Leader kit

Tracked links, ready-to-post messages, printable QR poster, club co-host link generator.

## 💬 WhatsApp journey

Register in chat + D-1 / H-1 / live / post nudges. Simulator runs the same spec n8n would.

## 📊 Command Center

Funnel, channel pace vs plan, A/B significance, forecast, leader nudges, CSV export.

## One loop, every step tracked

🚩 Leader posts tracked link → 📄 Student lands (ref + UTM + hook) → ★ Registers in 30 s → 📄 Shares Quest Pass → ❤️ Friends join → loot →  
 👑 College climbs Wars → 💬 WhatsApp nudges → 💻 Shows up & ships

**First idea → Anal:** a pretty landing page + Instagram ads → a peer-distribution system, after the CPL math showed ₹2,000 can't buy 500 sign-ups, and that trust, not reach, is the bottleneck.

**Rejected AI suggestions:** iPad lucky draw (wrong incentive), "only 50 seats left" (dishonest for Zoom), paid ads (math). Details on the AI Notes page.